

## 2.1 Action Games

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Nothing better to get the good old adrenalin pumping than an action game!

As the name suggests, action games have everything to do with fighting, guns, killing bad guys and saving the world. Action also happens to be the most well-known of all genres, and the most controversial at the same time. While gamers and developers go gaga over the latest action games, they also come in for a lot of flak from the media for promoting violence.

For instance, the Columbine shootings, where a school student shot a few of his classmates before killing himself, was blamed on the game *Doom*. Some claim that games such as *Doom* or *Grand Theft Auto* promote violence by rewarding it within the game. But at the same time, there are others who say that such games actually prevent real-life violence by providing a safe outlet for aggression. In the end, there is precious little scientific proof to support the view that violent games promote violence—so, assuming that you're mature enough, feel free to pick up one of these games and kick some bad-guy butt!